ii. **Bifoliolate:** When there are two leaflets articulated to the petiole it is said to be bifoliolate. Example: *Zornia diphylla*

iii. **Trifoliolate:** There are three leaflets articulated to the petiole it is said to be trifoliolate. Example: wood apple (*Aegle marmelos*), Clover (*Trifolium*).

iv. **Quadrifoliolate:** There are four leaflets articulated to the petiole it is said to be quadrifoliolate. Example: *Paris quadrifolia, Marsilia*

v. **Multifoliolate or digitate:** Five or more leaflets are joined and spread like fingers from the palm, as in *Cleome pentaphylla, Bombax ceiba*

3.7.6 Modification of Leaf

The main function of the leaf is food preparation by photosynthesis. Leaves modified to perform some specialized functions. They are described below.

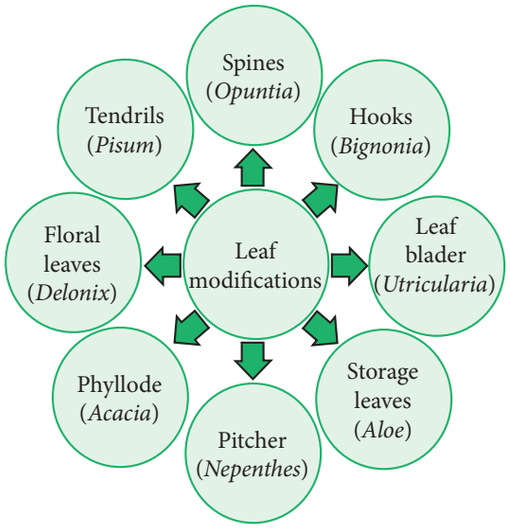
I. Leaf tendrils

In some plants stem is very weak and hence they have some special organs for attachment to the support. So some leaves are partially or wholly modified into tendril. Tendril is a slender wiry coiled structure which helps in climbing the support. Some of the modification of leaf tendrils are given below:

Entire leaf—*Lathyrus,* stipules—*Smilax,* terminal leaflet—*Naravelia,* Leaf tip— *Gloriosa,* Apical leaflet—*Pisum,* petiole— *Clematis.*

II. Leaf hooks

In some plants, leaves are modified into hook-like structures and help the plant to climb. In cat's nail (*Bignonia unguis-cati)* an elegant climber, the terminal leaflets become modified into three, very sharp, stiff and curved hooks, very much like the nails of a cat. These hooks cling to the bark of a tree and act as organs of support for climbing. The leaf spines of *Asparagus* also act as hooks.



III. Leaf Spines and Prickles

Leaves of certain plants develop spinesent structures. Either on the surface or on the margins as an adaptation to herbivory and xeric conditions. Example: *Zyzypus Argemone mexicana* (Prickly poppy), *Solanum trilobatum*. In xerophytes such as *Opuntia* (Prickly pear) and *Euphorbia* leaves and stipules are modified into spines.

Prickles are small, sharp structure which are the outgrowths from epidermal cells of stem or leaf. It helps the plant in scrambling over other plants. It is also protective against herbivory. Example: *Rosa spp.*

IV. Storage Leaves

Some plants of saline and xerophytic habitats and members of the family Crassulaceae commonly have fleshy or swollen leaves. These succulent leaves store water, mucilage or food material. Such storage leaves resist desiccation. Example: *Aloe, Agave, Bryophyllum*.

V. Phyllode

Phyllodes are flat, green-coloured leaf-like modifications of petioles or rachis. The leaflets or lamina of the leaf are highly reduced or caducous. The phyllodes perform photosynthesis and other functions of leaf. Example: *Acacia auriculiformis* (Australian *Acacia*), *Parkinsonia.*

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